

QUICK CARD - V2.1

Prompt Strategy Cheat Sheet

A concise reference for safer, more useful AI prompts in banking. Use it to strip sensitive data, give the model enough context, request a reviewable format, and keep a qualified human in the loop.

Use RCFC + R before asking AI to help

Role. Context. Format. Constraints. Review. If one line is missing, the output is harder to trust.

LINE	PROMPT MOVE	BANKING USE
Role	Tell the AI what perspective to use.	"You are a branch operations trainer..."
Context	Give the task, audience, and business setting.	"This is for frontline staff before a Monday huddle."
Format	Name the output shape.	"Return a 5-bullet checklist under 120 words."
Constraints	Set limits and red lines.	"Do not invent rates, policy requirements, or deadlines."
Review	State who checks it before use.	"A manager will verify before sending."

Copy-ready starter prompt

You are a [BANKING ROLE] helping with [TASK].
Context: [AUDIENCE], [SITUATION], [GOAL].
Format: [OUTPUT TYPE], [LENGTH], [ORDER].
Constraints: Use placeholders only. Do not invent facts, rates, fees, dates, legal conclusions, or policy requirements.
Review: Mark anything uncertain as [VERIFY]. A qualified human will review before use.

Strip specifics

Replace names, accounts, amounts, dates, addresses, and case facts with placeholders.

Ask for evidence

Tell the AI to separate facts, assumptions, and items requiring verification.

Control the format

Require bullets, tables, checklists, or drafts that a reviewer can scan quickly.

Pick the lane before the prompt

Green - usually safe

No sensitive data and no customer-impacting output. Examples: fictional training scenarios, blank checklists, public-source summaries, role-play prompts, and generic policy-reading aids.

Rule: if it could be written on a break-room whiteboard, it is usually Green.

Yellow - approved tool plus human review

The output could be seen by staff, customers, leadership, or examiners. Examples: campaign copy, policy training, internal procedures, meeting summaries, and customer-facing drafts using placeholders.

Rule: if the output will influence work, a qualified person reviews it before use.

Red - do not use public AI tools

Customer-specific decisions, SAR or AML investigations, adverse-action reasoning, legal conclusions, authentication decisions, confidential exams, vendor contracts, credentials, or production system details.

Rule: if it affects a customer, regulatory filing, control, or credential, treat it as Red until Compliance approves the workflow.

Five safe patterns bankers can reuse

USE WHEN	PROMPT PATTERN	HUMAN CHECK
Rewrite	Rewrite this for [AUDIENCE] in a [TONE] tone. Preserve meaning. Use placeholders only.	Meaning, tone, missing caveats.
Summarize	Summarize this public or approved text into [FORMAT]. Separate facts from assumptions.	Source accuracy and omissions.
Checklist	Turn this procedure into a checklist with owner, evidence, and escalation trigger.	Policy alignment and controls.
Compare	Compare these two redacted options. Return differences, risks, and [VERIFY] items.	Unsupported conclusions.
Train	Create a fictional practice scenario for [ROLE]. No real customers, employees, vendors, or accounts.	Realism without sensitive details.

Verification checklist

- ☐ No customer or employee personal data.
- ☐ No account, loan, card, login, token, or credential details.
- ☐ No invented rates, fees, dates, disclosures, or policy requirements.
- ☐ Facts are tied to an approved source or marked [VERIFY].
- ☐ Customer-facing language has a qualified reviewer.
- ☐ Regulatory, legal, fair-lending, BSA/AML, or security claims are escalated.
- ☐ The output is saved only in an approved system.
- ☐ The final owner is named before anyone acts on it.

Source basis: NIST AI Risk Management Framework, OWASP GenAI Top 10, Interagency Guidance on Third-Party Relationships, CFPB Regulation B, CFPB Regulation P, and FFIEC BSA/AML Manual risk concepts.

Adapt before adopting: This quick card is a training aid, not legal advice or an examiner-approved policy. Adapt it to your institution's approved tools, data classifications, records-retention rules, and review authority.